



MONKEY BUSINESS

News of The Funky Monkeys, Lynbrook High School Robotics, FIRST® Team 846



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Editor-in-Chief

Shambhavi Jyothirganesh



[Monkey Box YouTube Videos](#)

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 Co-President.....Prakhar Rathore
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 VP of Business.....Jiayi Zhou
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 Co-Design Ld.....Alexander Nicholson
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Presidents' Welcome



Saketh Neeli (sr.)

Prakhar Rathore (sr.)

When I first joined Lynbrook Robotics, I expected a club where people mostly worked quietly on robots. Instead, I found a team debating strange design ideas, eating dinner during late worksessions, and celebrating whenever a mechanism finally worked after hours of troubleshooting. The robot brings us together, but it is rarely the only thing people remember.

Robotics can feel intimidating at

[see Saketh's Welcome, page 4](#)

When people think of robotics, they usually imagine the robot flying across the field after six weeks of work. But when I think about robotics, that's not what comes to mind. One of my favorite memories is standing outside on a cold night, trying to figure out why our shooter wasn't working. We spent hours revising the math while eating Domino's pizza and celebrating every tiny improvement we made.

[see Prakhar's Welcome, page 2](#)

The New Building

Chenxia Liu (sr.)

For a long time, our old rooms defined my view of this team. At the peak of build season, we spent 50-hour weeks in our old shop, surrounded by cluttered tables, aluminum chips scattered

across the floor, machines squeezed together, and people constantly working only a couple feet apart. That experience is one I've come to know well during my past three years on the team, and because it was just what we had, it was hard not to accept it as normal.

I thought that was just what ro-

botics was: working around clutter, sharing limited space, and spending hours traveling to a shared community field just so our driver could practice. We still built amazing robots and learned a lot, but much of our effort went into working around the shop instead of being

[see The New Building, page 3](#)

Team Picnic

Bhavishya Pissay (sr.)

Team Picnic is one of our team's biggest traditions. It marks the end of one season while welcoming the new officer team as they step into roles of the previous officers. We celebrate everything we've accomplished together.

Planning the Team Picnic is probably one of the most rigorous and demanding events we organize. Every detail has to be considered from the amount of food to buy and making sure there are enough snacks and drinks, to organizing the games, supplies, and cleanup. Planning it is exciting but it comes with a lot of pressure. If you're off on something, and if the activities aren't planned well, the event won't be as enjoyable. It requires organization, communication, budgeting, and the ability to anticipate problems.

Despite all the work that goes into it, the picnic is always one of the most memorable team bonding. We get to put robotics aside for a day and simply enjoy spending time together. Whether it's a water balloon fight, volleyball, cardgames, or just talking over lunch, everyone

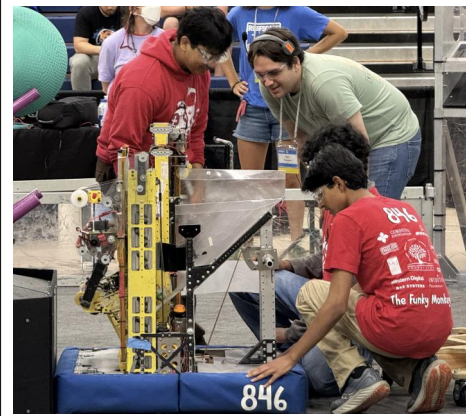


Jiayi, Charisse, and Jessica prepare for the water fight.

gets the chance to relax after a long season of hard work.

More importantly, the team picnic reminds us that our team is built on more than robots. Although throughout the season we spend hours designing, and building events like this strengthen the friendships that make collaboration possible in the first place. New members get to know returning students in a relaxed environment, graduating seniors can celebrate one last time with the team, and the incoming officers begin building relationships with the people they'll be working with. The picnic helps create a welcoming culture where everyone feels included, appreciated, and excited for the season ahead. 🤖

Prakhar's Welcome, Continued...



Prakhar Rathore (sr.) and Dhananjay Khulbe (sr.) setting up our robot before the match.

Moments like these are what I now associate with robotics, but when I first joined 846, I wasn't thinking about any of that. I was wondering whether I would fit in. I walked into my first worksession

One of my favorite memories is standing outside on a cold night, trying to figure out why our shooter wasn't working.

not knowing anyone or where to go. It seemed like everyone around me knew exactly what they were doing, while I had no idea what I could contribute. But just by showing up to worksessions, I learned so much and became friends with so many different people I never knew before.

Our new workspace gives us more room to design, prototype, and collaborate than ever before. Whether you're joining with years of experience or are stepping into a worksession for the first time, I hope you find the same sense of belonging that I found! I can't wait to see the ideas you bring, the robots we build, and the memories we create together in the future! 🤖

Thank You to Our Sponsors...



Community

Harish Gottimukkula (jr.)

If you told me two years ago that The Funky Monkeys would be my second home, I wouldn't have believed you. I was moving to a new school, only knowing a handful of people, and before I joined the team, I had never done any sort of robotics and I didn't know anyone in the club. But as workshops commenced, I found myself attending. At the time, I wasn't sure whether it was because I wanted to fill my free time or because I had taken an interest in the assembly and electrical concepts I was learning, as well as the ability to create something using the machines we had. But I found myself slowly making friends and

joining the community.

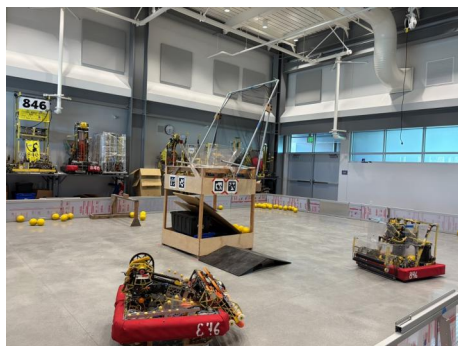
However, the idea of working on the robot still felt out of reach. In fact, when kickoff rolled around, I almost didn't go because I feared that as a rookie member, I wouldn't be taken seriously and would just sit on the sidelines. But reluctantly, I still went, and I think that was one of the best decisions I've made. The kickoff was nothing like what I feared. I got to go up with a group of people and present my ideas for autos. I got to provide input on what we would want on the robot. I truly felt like a member of the robotics club, and ever since, I have been involving myself more and more in this club. Some of my closest friends are from robotics, and some of my best memories in

high school so far are from competitions and work sessions. I am thankful for what The Funky Monkeys community has done for me, and I hope to pay it forward during my time on the team. 🤖

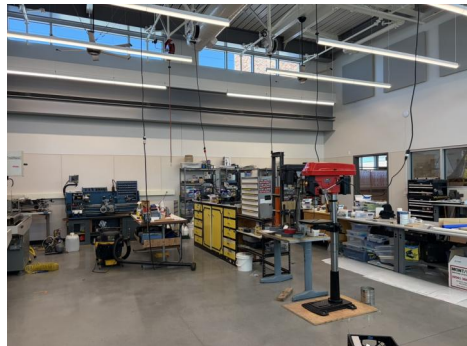


Harish Gottimukkula (jr.) preparing to machine an L bracket.

The New Building, Continued...



We can finally drive indoors in our Test & Drive room!



We have space in our machine shop for new machinery!

Small Features, a Big Difference

Anish Rao (sr.)

I remember being asked as an underclassman by subsystem leads to check if there was stock in our shop to make something they wanted. The process of checking was always time consuming — a matter of tripping over our stand-up pile of large stock, maybe picking a large piece up and poking the short ceiling. If not there, the search would go through racks, drawers, and bins of various unorganized materials. Our materials were in a mess because there just wasn't space to keep it all. It was as if this endless search was a necessary rite of passage to make anything. It was a relatively small thing, but it got in everyone's way every time.

So when I first saw our new room [see Small Features, a Big Diff., page 4](#)

supported by it. While our old rooms taught us to be resourceful, they also limited what we could accomplish.

The new facility can change that. With a practice field of our own, better storage, and a much larger shop, the new building gives us room to stay organized, train new members, practice more of-

ten, and let more people contribute at once without getting in each other's way. Instead of losing time to travel or searching for tools, we can be much more productive. Just as the new building expanded my view of what robotics could be, it will also expand our expectations for what this team can achieve in the future. 🤖

More than anything, it shows that our team still has plenty of room to grow.

Small Features, a Big Difference,

Continued...

botics facility, I was wowed by it, not just because it was tailored for us but because it had potential to solve the smaller, yet still important, problems. For one, there is much more room to organize things, so we have come up with systems to conveniently organize our materials while effectively managing overall space. We rearranged how we store stock to clearly separate different materials and are experimenting with tools, such as an app, to keep track of all stock.

There are other small details like the floors being made of concrete. This is big since our old machine shop was a portable classroom with raised wooden floors, meaning our largest machines could have fallen through the floor when we first moved them in. Now our machines can be as big as we want. There are other upgrades from the old facilities, like double-wide doors that can fit anything unlike the old classroom doors which could barely fit robots, let alone machines. Our old facilities were

useful while they lasted, but ultimately the walls were bursting open on our team. The new facility is also a new beginning for us, and in the coming years I know our team will expand more freely and reach new heights in it. 🤖

Saketh's Welcome, Continued...



Saketh Neeli (sr.) sets the slipping force on a winch brake using a torque wrench.

first. There are unfamiliar machines, complicated CAD models, and people who seem to already know what they are doing. But no one

starts out knowing how to design, machine, program, or speak to judges. You learn by showing up, asking questions, trying new things, and making a few mistakes along the way.

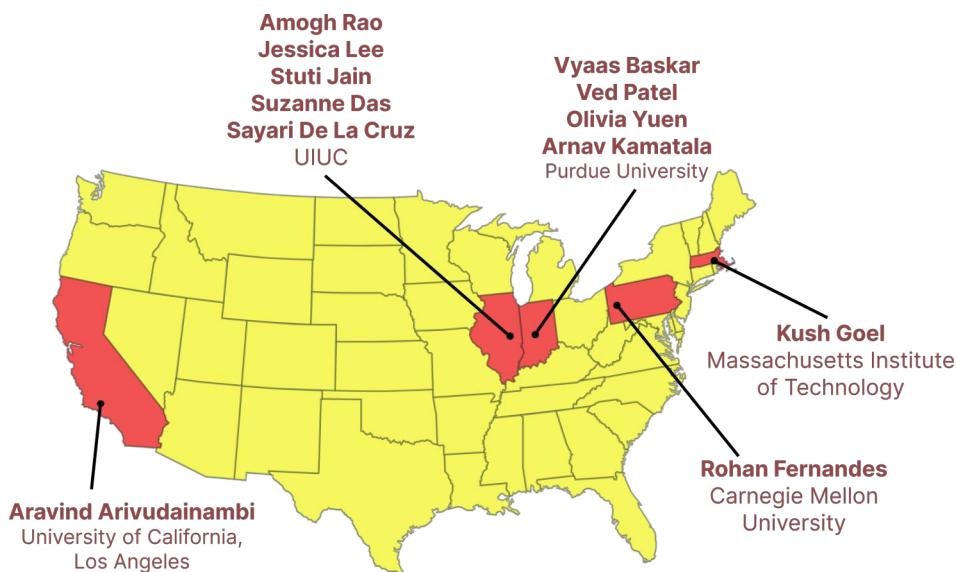
There is also much more to 846 than engineering. Members create graphics, organize outreach events, write grants, develop strategy, manage finances, and teach robotics in the community. Whatever your interests are, there is a place for you here.

*What makes 846 special
is our willingness to try
unusual ideas.*

Some ideas work, many do not, but all of them teach us something. Do not be afraid to speak up because you are new or think your idea sounds strange. This team is usually crazy enough to try it.

With our new workspace, we have more room than ever to design, prototype, and collaborate. I hope you use it to learn new skills, meet new people, and contribute your own ideas. Welcome to Lynbrook Robotics! 🤖

Where Can You Find the Class of 2026?



FALL WORKSHOPS STARTING 9/21

Design (Mon): 4:00-6:00

Media (Tue): 4:00-6:00

Electrical (Wed): 3:15-5:15

Machining (Thur): 4:00-6:00

Software (Fri): 3:15-5:15